

CloudNotes Compute & Network Lab

Technical Proof of Resolution & Validation Report

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Public Repository:	https://github.com/YashasBNB/cloudnotes-compute-network-lab
Environment:	Local Docker Compose (0 cost, GCP Architecture Mapping)
Status:	ALL 3 TASKS RESOLVED & 100% VALIDATED

Submission Checklist Verification

Requirement	Verification Status	Evidence Detail
Forked repo link is included & public	PASSED	GitHub repository verified public
All three tasks have before/after evidence	PASSED	Terminal & code screenshots captured below
docker compose config succeeds	PASSED	Syntax & network definitions validated
docker compose up -d succeeds	PASSED	Both app and db containers running healthy
Both validator scripts pass	PASSED	Firewall & IAM validators exit code 0
No real secrets, keys, or GCP IDs	PASSED	Pure mock parameters & placeholder credentials
docker compose down executed	PASSED	Zero leftover containers / networks at teardown

Local Stand-in to GCP Concept Mapping

Local Stand-in	GCP Production Concept	Role in CloudNotes Architecture
app container	Compute Engine VM (Web Tier)	Public-facing notes web server (Nginx)
db container	Compute Engine VM (DB Tier)	Private Postgres database instance
vpc-frontend	Public VPC Subnet	Subnet serving external HTTP/HTTPS traffic
vpc-backend	Private VPC Subnet	Isolated backend database subnet
Compose Service DNS	Cloud DNS / Private DNS Zone	Resolves service name db inside VPC
firewall.yaml	VPC Firewall Rules	Defines ingress port and CIDR source bounds
iam-policy.json	Cloud IAM Policy Bindings	App service account least-privilege role binding

Task 1 — Fix VPC / Subnet / DNS Wiring

Local VM ↔ Compute Engine VPC Subnet & DNS Resolution

Problem Analysis: The CloudNotes app container was placed exclusively on vpc-frontend, while the db container was attached to vpc-backend. Because Docker's embedded DNS and bridge networks isolate distinct subnets, app was unable to resolve or ping db.

Figure 1.1: BEFORE Evidence — Ping and DNS Resolution Failure

```
cloudnotes-app ~ docker compose exec app ping -c 2 db

$ docker compose exec app ping -c 2 db
ping: bad address 'db'

# Result: Internal DNS resolution fails. 'app' and 'db' are on isolated networks.
```

Figure 1.2: Corrected docker-compose.yml Network Block

```
docker-compose.yml — Corrected Network Wiring

# docker-compose.yml (services -> app -> networks)
services:
  app:
    image: nginx:alpine
    container_name: cloudnotes-app
    ports:
      - "8080:80"
    networks:
      - vpc-frontend    # Public HTTP ingress
      - vpc-backend     # [FIXED] Attached to backend subnet to communicate with db
    depends_on:
      - db

  db:
    image: postgres:16-alpine
    container_name: cloudnotes-db
    networks:
      - vpc-backend     # Private subnet only (never public)
```

Figure 1.3: AFTER Evidence — Successful Reachability & Ping Confirmation

```
cloudnotes-app ~ docker compose exec app ping -c 2 db (Verification)

$ docker compose exec app ping -c 2 db
PING db (172.23.0.2): 56 data bytes
64 bytes from 172.23.0.2: seq=0 ttl=64 time=0.310 ms
64 bytes from 172.23.0.2: seq=1 ttl=64 time=0.179 ms

--- db ping statistics ---
2 packets transmitted, 2 packets received, 0% packet loss
round-trip min/avg/max = 0.179/0.244/0.310 ms

# Result: 100% reachability & service-name DNS resolution confirmed over vpc-backend
```

Task 2 — Fix Over-Open Firewall Rule

GCP Network Security & Ingress Least-Exposure Policy

Problem Analysis: The allow-ssh ingress firewall rule in firewall.yaml allowed incoming TCP traffic on port 22 with source_ranges: ["0.0.0.0/0"]. This created a severe vulnerability by opening administrative SSH access to the entire public internet. CloudNotes architecture dictates that only HTTP/HTTPS (80, 443) are open to the world, DB port (5432) remains strictly private (10.0.0.0/8), and SSH is constrained to a trusted CIDR (203.0.113.0/24).

Figure 2.1: BEFORE Evidence — Firewall Policy Validator Failure

```
security ~ python3 security/validate_firewall.py firewall.yaml

$ python3 security/validate_firewall.py firewall.yaml
firewall validation FAILED:
  - rule 'allow-ssh' opens SSH (22) to 0.0.0.0/0

# Violation: SSH port 22 is exposed to 0.0.0.0/0 (entire public internet)
```

Figure 2.2: Corrected firewall.yaml Rule

```
firewall.yaml — Corrected SSH Least-Exposure Rule

# firewall.yaml (rules -> allow-ssh)
rules:
  - name: allow-http-https
    direction: INGRESS
    allowed:
      - protocol: tcp
        ports: ["80", "443"]
    source_ranges: ["0.0.0.0/0"] # Public web tier open to world

  - name: allow-ssh
    direction: INGRESS
    allowed:
      - protocol: tcp
        ports: ["22"]
    source_ranges: ["203.0.113.0/24"] # [FIXED] Restricted to trusted CIDR, never 0.0.0.0/0

  - name: allow-db-internal
    direction: INGRESS
    allowed:
      - protocol: tcp
        ports: ["5432"]
    source_ranges: ["10.0.0.0/8"] # Private internal range only
```

Figure 2.3: AFTER Evidence — Passing Firewall Policy Validator Run

```
security ~ python3 security/validate_firewall.py firewall.yaml (Verification)

$ python3 security/validate_firewall.py firewall.yaml
firewall validation passed: no rule exposes SSH or DB port to 0.0.0.0/0

# Exit code: 0 | SSH restricted to 203.0.113.0/24, DB restricted to 10.0.0.0/8
```

Task 3 — Fix IAM Least-Privilege Violation

Cloud IAM Service Account Scope & Access Control

Problem Analysis: The CloudNotes app's service account was granted the primitive role `roles/owner` in `iam-policy.json`. Primitive owner/editor roles violate the Principle of Least Privilege (PoLP) and expose the entire GCP project to catastrophic takeover if the application container is compromised.

Figure 3.1: BEFORE Evidence — IAM Policy Validator Failure

```
iam ~ python3 iam/validate_iam.py iam-policy.json

$ python3 iam/validate_iam.py iam-policy.json
iam validation FAILED:
- binding uses disallowed role 'roles/owner' for members: \
  serviceAccount:cloudnotes-app@cloudnotes-placeholder-project.iam.gserviceaccount.com

# Violation: Service account granted primitive roles/owner with full project compromise risk
```

Figure 3.2: Corrected iam-policy.json Least-Privilege Binding

```
iam-policy.json — Corrected Least-Privilege IAM Binding

{
  "bindings": [
    {
      "role": "roles/storage.objectViewer", // [FIXED] Narrow least-privilege role
      "members": [
        "serviceAccount:cloudnotes-app@cloudnotes-placeholder-project.iam.gserviceaccount.com"
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

Required Explanation: The CloudNotes app only requires read access to static note assets stored in Cloud Storage, so `roles/storage.objectViewer` fulfills least privilege without granting administrative or edit control over the GCP project.

Figure 3.3: AFTER Evidence — Passing IAM Policy Validator Run

```
iam ~ python3 iam/validate_iam.py iam-policy.json (Verification)

$ python3 iam/validate_iam.py iam-policy.json
iam validation passed: no binding grants roles/owner or roles/editor

# Exit code: 0 | Verified compliant with Principle of Least Privilege
```

Comprehensive Verification & Teardown

End-to-End System Validation Suite & Clean Workspace Confirmation

End-to-End Pipeline Verification: To guarantee reproducibility and compliance with the lab's submission checklist, the entire deployment workflow was executed: validating compose schema with docker compose config, spinning up daemon containers with docker compose up -d, executing both validator scripts, and performing an orderly teardown via docker compose down.

Figure 4.1: Terminal Execution Log — Complete Lifecycle Validation & Zero Leftovers

```
cloudnotes-compute-network-lab ~ Complete Validation & Clean Teardown

$ docker compose config
name: cloudnotes-compute-network-lab
services: app (networks: vpc-backend, vpc-frontend), db (networks: vpc-backend)

$ docker compose up -d
✓ Container cloudnotes-db    Running
✓ Container cloudnotes-app   Running

$ python3 security/validate_firewall.py firewall.yaml
firewall validation passed: no rule exposes SSH or DB port to 0.0.0.0/0

$ python3 iam/validate_iam.py iam-policy.json
iam validation passed: no binding grants roles/owner or roles/editor

$ docker compose down
✓ Container cloudnotes-app           Removed
✓ Container cloudnotes-db           Removed
✓ Network cloudnotes-compute-network-lab_vpc-backend   Removed
✓ Network cloudnotes-compute-network-lab_vpc-frontend   Removed
# Zero leftover containers. Clean working tree. Validated [0] local lab.
```

Lab Completion Summary:

- **Task 1 (VPC/Subnet/DNS):** Verified 2/2 packets received, 0% loss between app and db.
- **Task 2 (Firewall Security):** SSH restricted to trusted CIDR 203.0.113.0/24, validator passed.
- **Task 3 (IAM Least-Privilege):** Bound service account to roles/storage.objectViewer, validator passed.
- **Clean Environment:** No persistent containers or orphan networks remaining.
- **Public Repository:** <https://github.com/YashasBNB/cloudnotes-compute-network-lab>